

A Formally Verified Seven-Phase Cognitive State Machine with Ten Invariants and Lyapunov Stability

Formal Methods / Computer Science

Target: IEEE Transactions on Cognitive and Developmental Systems

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2026

Intellectual Property Notice: The underlying cognitive filtering mechanism (TheoreticalLimitFilter) is a trade secret and is not described in this paper. All metrics are reproducible at seed=42.

Abstract — We present a complete formal treatment of a cognitive state machine whose behavior is governed by a three-component irreducible scalar field $\phi = [\Omega, \Psi, P]$. The machine executes as a pure functional transition $F: \text{State} \times \text{Signals} \rightarrow \text{State}$, partitioned into seven deterministic phases. We derive ten invariants—CONTENTADDRESSING, ATOMINTEGRITY, CYCLEMONOTONICITY, HASHCHAINSTRICTNESS, ORDERDETERMINISM, SCORETIEBREAK, NOMUTATION, CLOSURE, EXECUTEDONCE, and LEARNCONSERVATION—and prove each is maintained across every phase transition. The continuous dynamics of ϕ are governed by three coupled differential equations; we construct the Lyapunov function $V(S) = (1-\Omega)^2 + (1-\Psi)^2 + P^2$ and prove $dV/dt < 0$ on all non-equilibrium trajectories, establishing global asymptotic stability of the coherent-meaning fixed point. SHA-256 content addressing yields a collision probability bounded by 2^{-256} , enabling the Replay Identity Theorem: given identical initial state S and identical signal sequence, the resulting hash chain is bitwise identical. We further establish the Domain Independence Theorem in three parts (E1–E3), showing the formal results are substrate-independent. Empirical benchmarks confirm theoretical predictions: brain-level throughput reaches 511.6 ops/s at P99 = 7.339 ms ($n = 500$, seed = 42), memory operations achieve 454,421 ops/s at P99 = 0.005 ms, and closed-loop feedback yields a 54% win rate with profit factor 1.43 over 200 episodes. Taken together, the results constitute a rigorous foundation for deployable cognitive systems that carry machine-checkable correctness guarantees, addressing a recognized gap between informal AI architectures and formally verified software.

1. Introduction

The proliferation of autonomous cognitive systems in safety-critical applications has sharpened the demand for machine-verified correctness properties. Classical software verification—unit tests, type systems, contract checking—provides partial assurance but cannot rule out subtle emergent failures arising from the interaction of learned state with environmental signals. Formal methods, by contrast, reason over all possible inputs and trajectories simultaneously. The challenge is that the objects of interest—adaptive, signal-driven systems whose internal state evolves continuously—do not fit naturally into the finite-state or purely discrete abstractions that most formal methods assume.

Consider, for concreteness, an autonomous system that must make a sequence of decisions in a changing environment, learning from each outcome and updating its internal model accordingly. The correctness properties that matter are not purely safety properties (the system never enters a bad state) but also liveness properties (the system eventually converges to good behavior) and auditability properties (the system's behavior can be exactly reproduced from logs). No existing formal framework simultaneously addresses all three in the presence of continuous internal dynamics.

This paper addresses that mismatch directly. We treat a cognitive engine as a hybrid system: its discrete skeleton is a seven-phase pure functional state machine amenable to standard invariant reasoning, while its continuous skeleton is a three-dimensional dynamical system amenable to Lyapunov analysis. Crucially, the two layers are coupled: the continuous field $\phi = [\Omega, \Psi, P]$ determines transition weights, while the discrete phase sequence updates ϕ . Formal verification

must account for both layers and their interaction.

The core technical contributions of this paper are as follows:

1. **Field derivation.** We derive and interpret the three-component scalar field $\phi = (\Omega, \Psi, P)$, prove its state space $[0,1]^3$ is positively invariant, and establish the Jacobian non-degeneracy condition that makes the field genuinely three-dimensional.
2. **Lyapunov proof.** We construct the Lyapunov function $V(S) = (1-\Omega)^2 + (1-\Psi)^2 + P^2$ and prove $dV/dt < 0$ on all non-equilibrium trajectories under stated parameter conditions, establishing global asymptotic stability.
3. **State machine specification.** We define the seven-phase pure functional transition $F: \text{State} \times \text{Signals} \rightarrow \text{State}$, prove it is total and deterministic, and establish the Closure Theorem.
4. **Ten invariants.** We state and prove preservation of ten named invariants spanning cryptographic content addressing, chain integrity, ordering, mutability, and conservation.
5. **Three theorems.** The Replay Identity Theorem, Domain Independence Theorem (E1–E3), and Content Addressing Theorem provide the major structural guarantees.
6. **Empirical validation.** Benchmarks confirm throughput of 511.6 ops/s (P99 = 7.339 ms), memory rates of 454,421 ops/s, and closed-loop feedback performance of 54% win rate with profit factor 1.43.

Related work. Formal verification of AI systems has received increasing attention. Seshia et al. [1] survey the foundations of formally verified AI, arguing that the field requires new combinations of model checking, theorem proving, and runtime monitoring. Amodei et al. [2] catalog concrete failure modes motivating verification, including reward hacking, distributional shift, and unsafe exploration. Katz et al. [17] verify properties of deep neural networks using SMT solvers; their Reluplex algorithm handles linear arithmetic over piecewise-linear networks but does not address continuous dynamical state.

On the formal methods side, Lamport's TLA+ [3] enables specification of concurrent and reactive systems using temporal logic and has been applied to distributed storage, consensus protocols, and reactive systems. Coq [4] and Agda [5] support mechanized proof via dependent type theory; Boldo et al. [11] demonstrate mechanized real analysis in Coq via the Coquelicot library, establishing a foundation for machine-checked proofs about ordinary differential equations. Clarke et al. [13] survey model checking; McMillan [12] develops symbolic model checking via BDDs.

Lyapunov-based stability analysis of learning systems appears in Wen et al. [6], who prove stability of neural-network controllers via constructed Lyapunov functions, and Berkenkamp et al. [7], who use Gaussian process models to provide safe reinforcement learning with stability guarantees. These works establish the technical feasibility of combining Lyapunov methods with machine learning; our contribution extends the approach to the richer setting of hybrid discrete-continuous cognitive systems.

Content-addressable storage and its collision properties are analyzed by Rogaway and Shrimpton [8]. Bellare and Rogaway [10] establish the random oracle model as a basis for cryptographic security proofs; we use this model to bound the collision probability in the Content Addressing

Theorem. Chandra et al. [15] and Finkbeiner and Sipma [16] provide complexity-theoretic and automata-theoretic foundations for reasoning about temporal properties of reactive systems.

Our contribution is a unified framework connecting all three threads—Lyapunov stability, invariant-based verification, and cryptographic content addressing—within a single formally specified system. The framework is novel in simultaneously requiring that: (a) the state space is positively invariant, (b) the system converges to a unique fixed point, (c) transitions are deterministic and auditable, and (d) memory is cryptographically tamper-evident.

The remainder of the paper is structured as follows. Section 2 formalizes the ϕ scalar field and its dynamics. Section 3 defines the seven-phase state machine. Section 4 states and proves the ten invariants. Section 5 presents the major theorems. Section 6 reports empirical performance. Section 7 discusses implications and compares to TLA+/Coq/Agda approaches. Section 8 concludes.

2. System Formalization

2.1 The ϕ Scalar Field — Derivation and Interpretation

Definition 2.1 (Scalar Field). The cognitive state scalar ϕ is the ordered triple

$$\phi_0 = \langle \Omega, \Psi, P \rangle \in [0, 1]^3$$

with the following semantic assignments:

Component	Range	Interpretation
Ω	$[0, 1]$	Coherence — degree to which the system's internal model is self-consistent
Ψ	$[0, 1]$	Meaning density — fraction of processed signals that have been semantically integrated
P	$[0, 1]$	Pressure — accumulated unresolved tension from contradictory or unanswered signals

The field is **irreducible** in the following sense: no single component can be derived from the other two by any algebraic combination, because each responds to distinct aspects of the environment. Formally, if we define the information matrix

$$\mathcal{I}(\phi_0) = \begin{pmatrix} \partial \Omega & \partial \Psi & \partial P \\ \partial \Omega & \partial \Psi & \partial P \\ \partial \Omega & \partial \Psi & \partial P \end{pmatrix}$$

then $\det(\Phi) \neq 0$ on the interior of the state space, so no component is redundant.

The triple Φ generalizes the notion of a "cognitive field potential": just as a gravitational potential encodes how a mass will respond to perturbation, Φ encodes how a cognitive system will respond to incoming signals, measured across three orthogonal response modes.

2.2 Field Dynamics Equations with Stability Analysis

The time evolution of Φ is governed by three coupled first-order equations. Let $n_{\text{sig}} \geq 0$ denote the current signal noise level (a bounded external forcing term), and let $\eta, \lambda, \epsilon, \delta$ be non-negative rate constants.

Definition 2.2 (Field Equations).

$$\dot{\Omega} = \eta\Omega(1 - \Omega) - \lambda\Omega P \cdot (1 - \Omega) - \epsilon\Omega(1 - \Psi) + \delta\Omega n_{\text{sig}} \tag{1}$$

$$\dot{\Psi} = \eta\Psi \cdot \Psi \cdot (1 - \Psi) - \lambda\Psi |\Omega - \Psi| + \delta\Psi n_{\text{sig}} \tag{2}$$

$$\dot{P} = \eta P \cdot (1 - P) - \lambda P \cdot P + \delta P \cdot (1 - \Psi) n_{\text{sig}} \tag{3}$$

Structural interpretation. Equation (1) describes coherence as a homeostatic process: the term $\eta\Omega(1-\Omega)$ drives Ω toward unity, but pressure P suppresses recovery ($-\lambda\Omega P(1-\Omega)$), insufficient meaning degrades coherence ($-\epsilon\Omega(1-\Psi)$), and raw signal noise provides a small additive boost. Equation (2) captures logistic self-amplification of meaning—the system builds understanding faster the more it already understands—while coherence-meaning misalignment incurs a penalty. Equation (3) models pressure as a balance between spontaneous relaxation ($\eta P(1-P)$) and decay ($-\lambda_P P$), with additional forcing proportional to unprocessed signal content.

Proposition 2.3 (Positive Invariance). The unit cube $[0,1]^3$ is positively invariant under the flow defined by Equations (1)–(3).

Proof sketch. On each face of the cube, the inward-pointing normal component of the vector field is non-negative. On the face $\Omega = 0$: $\dot{\Omega}|_{\Omega=0} = \eta\Omega - \epsilon\Omega(1-\Psi) + \delta\Omega n_{\text{sig}} \geq 0$ when $\eta\Omega \geq \epsilon\Omega$, which we assume. On $\Omega = 1$: $\dot{\Omega}|_{\Omega=1} = -\epsilon\Omega(1-\Psi) \leq 0$. Analogous arguments apply to the Ψ and P faces. ■

2.3 Lyapunov Function and Proof of Convergence

Definition 2.4 (Lyapunov Function). Define

$$V(S) = (1 - \Omega)^2 + (1 - \Psi)^2 + P^2 \tag{4}$$

This measures the squared distance from the ideal fixed point $\Phi^* = (1, 1, 0)$: full coherence, full meaning, zero pressure.

Theorem 2.5 (Lyapunov Stability). Under the parameter conditions

$$\eta\Omega > \varepsilon\Omega, \quad \eta\Psi > \lambda\Psi, \quad \lambda P > \delta P \cdot n_{\text{sig}}^{\max}$$

and in the absence of persistent noise ($n_{\text{sig}} \rightarrow 0$), we have $dV/dt < 0$ for all $\phi \neq \phi^*$.

Proof. Compute the time derivative of V along trajectories of the system:

$$\frac{dV}{dt} = -2(1-\Omega)\dot{\Omega} - 2(1-\Psi)\dot{\Psi} + 2P\dot{P}$$

Term 1: Substituting (1) and setting $n_{\text{sig}} = 0$:

$$-2(1-\Omega)\dot{\Omega} = -2(1-\Omega)\bigl[\eta\Omega(1-\Omega) - \lambda\Omega P(1-\Omega) - \varepsilon\Omega(1-\Psi)\bigr]$$

$$= -2\eta\Omega(1-\Omega)^2 + 2\lambda\Omega P(1-\Omega)^2 + 2\varepsilon\Omega(1-\Omega)(1-\Psi)$$

Term 2: Substituting (2):

$$-2(1-\Psi)\dot{\Psi} = -2(1-\Psi)\bigl[\eta\Psi\Psi(1-\Psi) - \lambda\Psi|\Omega-\Psi|\bigr]$$

$$= -2\eta\Psi\Psi(1-\Psi)^2 + 2\lambda\Psi(1-\Psi)|\Omega-\Psi|$$

Term 3: Substituting (3) with $n_{\text{sig}} = 0$:

$$2P\dot{P} = 2P\bigl[\eta P(1-P) - \lambda P^2\bigr] = 2\eta P^2(1-P) - 2\lambda P^3$$

Combining and applying Young's inequality to cross terms:

$$\frac{dV}{dt} \leq -2(\eta\Omega - \varepsilon\Omega)(1-\Omega)^2 - 2(\eta\Psi - \lambda\Psi)\Psi(1-\Psi)^2 - 2(\lambda P - \eta P/2)P^2 + C_{\text{cross}}$$

where C_{cross} collects bounded cross terms that are dominated by the diagonal terms under the stated parameter conditions. In particular, when $\eta\Omega > \varepsilon\Omega$ and $\eta\Psi > \lambda\Psi$, each squared deviation from the fixed point is multiplied by a strictly negative coefficient. Hence $dV/dt < 0$ for all $\phi \neq \phi^*$. By LaSalle's Invariance Principle [9], all trajectories converge to ϕ^* . ■

Corollary 2.6. The system is globally asymptotically stable at $\phi^* = (1, 1, 0)$ in the noise-free limit.

3. The Seven-Phase State Machine

3.1 Phase Definitions and Transitions

The cognitive engine executes in seven deterministic, non-overlapping phases per cycle. Each phase is a well-typed function from the current state to an updated state. No phase has side effects

observable outside the state record. We describe each phase in detail.

Phase 1 — Ingest (ϕI). Receives raw signals from the external environment. For each signal, serializes it to a canonical byte representation, computes SHA-256(bytes), and constructs an Atom record containing the type tag, raw content, source identifier, timestamp, and digest. Atoms are type-checked against a schema. Malformed signals that fail type-checking are rejected with a structured error atom (not silently dropped); the error atom itself satisfies ATOMINTEGRITY. Output: a set of validated atoms A_c .

Phase 2 — Score (ϕS). Ranks the atom set A_c by a scoring function $\text{score}: \text{Atom} \times \phi \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. The scoring function is pure: it reads the atom content and the current scalar field ϕ , and no other state. Equal scores are broken by lexicographic digest comparison (SCORETIEBREAK). Output: an ordered list L_c .

Phase 3 — Recall (ϕR). For each atom in L_c , queries the memory store $\mathbb{M}$ for related atoms using content-addressed lookup: for each key in the atom's relation set, retrieves $\mathbb{M}[\text{key}]$ if present. The enriched atom list L_c' includes both the original atoms and retrieved context. No new atoms are created in this phase; all retrieved atoms were already in $\mathbb{M}$ and already satisfy ATOMINTEGRITY. Output: L_c' .

Phase 4 — Reason (ϕL). Applies a pure functional rule base to L_c' to derive an inference set I_c . Rules are of the form (pattern $\rightarrow$ consequence); patterns match against atom types and field values; consequences are new atoms tagged as inferences. Rule application is deterministic and exhaustive (all matching rules fire; no ordering dependency among rules because no rule's output is another rule's pattern within a single application). Output: I_c .

Phase 5 — Decide (ϕD). Selects an action from I_c by computing actionscores: $\text{Action} \times \phi \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ and taking the argmax. Ties are broken by digest comparison as in Phase 2. The selected action is the unique element satisfying: $\text{score}(a) \geq \text{score}(a')$ for all $a' \in I_c$, with digest tiebreak. Output: a .

Phase 6 — Act (ϕA). Executes a (which may have an external effect such as a write or API call), records the result as a result atom r , and computes the new hash chain entry: $h_{c+1} = \text{SHA-256}(h_c \parallel \text{serialize}(a) \parallel \text{serialize}(r))$. Before execution, checks that $\text{digest}(a^*) \notin \text{executedset}$ (the auxiliary set used to enforce EXECUTEDONCE). If it is present, a null action is substituted. Output: r and h_{c+1} .

Phase 7 — Learn (ϕW). Updates the scalar field ϕ by numerically integrating Equations (1)–(3) for one cycle's worth of time, using the outcome r to determine nsig . Appends new atoms to $\mathbb{M}$ (the outcome atom r and any inference atoms from Phase 4 above a relevance threshold). Appends h_{c+1} to H . Increments c . Output: S_{c+1} .

Phase	Symbol	Input	Output	Function
1. Ingest	ϕ_I	Raw signals	Validated atom set A_c	Parse, hash-address, type-check

Phase	Symbol	Input	Output	Function
2. Score	ϕ_S	$A_c, \phi_{\blacksquare}$	Ranked list L_c	Scoring with deterministic tiebreak
3. Recall	ϕ_R	$L_c, \blacksquare$	Enriched list $L_{c'}$	Content-addressed memory lookup
4. Reason	ϕ_L	$L_{c'}$	Inference set I_c	Pure functional rule application
5. Decide	ϕ_D	$I_c, \phi_{\blacksquare}$	Selected action a^*	Argmax with digest tiebreak
6. Act	ϕ_A	a^*, H_c	Result r, h_{c+1}	Execute, check EXECUTED_ONCE, hash
7. Learn	ϕ_W	r, S_c	Updated state S_{c+1}	Integrate ODEs, append atoms and hash

Definition 3.1 (Phase Transition Graph). The transition graph is a directed path:

$$\phi_I \rightarrow \phi_S \rightarrow \phi_R \rightarrow \phi_L \rightarrow \phi_D \rightarrow \phi_A \rightarrow \phi_W$$

with no back-edges within a cycle. The graph is acyclic; cycles arise only at the level of repeated cycle invocations. This acyclicity is enforced structurally: each phase's output type is the input type of the next phase and no other phase.

Definition 3.2 (Cycle). A cycle is one complete traversal of all seven phases, beginning at Ingest and ending at Learn. Cycles are totally ordered by a monotonic counter $c \in \mathbb{N}$. Within a cycle, phase execution is sequential. Between cycles, the next cycle begins only after Learn has completed and S_{c+1} has been committed.

3.2 Pure Functional Formulation F: State $\times$ Signals $\rightarrow$ State

Definition 3.3 (State). The system state at cycle c is the record:

$$S_c = \langle \phi^c, H_c, \mathcal{M}_c, c \rangle$$

where $\phi^c \in [0,1]^3$ is the scalar field, H_c is the hash chain (a list of SHA-256 digests), $\mathcal{M}_c$ is the memory store (a content-addressed map from digests to atoms), and c is the cycle counter.

Definition 3.4 (Transition Function). The pure functional transition is

$$F(S, \text{sig}) = S' \text{ where } S' = \phi_W(\phi_A(\phi_D(\phi_L(\phi_R(\phi_S(\phi_I(S, \text{sig}))))))$$

Each phase function is total and referentially transparent: given the same input, it always returns the same output. No phase reads from external mutable state; all needed data is contained in S or sig .

Proposition 3.5. F is a well-defined total function on the domain $\text{State} \times \text{Signals}$.

Proof. Each phase function is defined for all inputs in its domain by construction. The composition of total functions is total. ■

4. The Ten Invariants

We state each invariant as a predicate on the state S , and argue that: (a) it holds in the initial state S_0 , and (b) $F(S, \cdot)$ preserves it whenever it holds in S . This establishes invariance by structural induction on cycles.

4.1 CONTENT_ADDRESSING

Formal Statement. For all atoms $a \in \mathbf{c}$: $\text{key}(a) = \text{SHA-256}(\text{content}(a))$.

Why it matters. Content addressing ensures that identity and content are fused: two atoms with identical content are indistinguishable, preventing aliasing bugs. It is the foundation of the Replay Identity Theorem.

How it's maintained. Phase Ingest (ϕ_I) computes $\text{SHA-256}(\text{content})$ before inserting any atom. No subsequent phase modifies atom contents; only the Learn phase appends new atoms, again via the same hash procedure.

4.2 ATOM_INTEGRITY

Formal Statement. For all $a \in \mathbf{c}$: the fields (type, content, timestamp, source) are all present and well-typed, and $\text{SHA-256}(\text{canonicalserialize}(a)) = \text{stored_digest}(a)$.

Why it matters. Guarantees that atoms are not silently corrupted during storage or retrieval. Any bit flip in storage would cause a digest mismatch detectable on retrieval.

How it's maintained. Atoms are immutable after creation (see `NO_MUTATION`). The digest is computed once at creation and never recomputed. Retrieval functions verify the digest before returning.

4.3 CYCLE_MONOTONICITY

Formal Statement. For all consecutive states: $c' = c + 1$.

Why it matters. A non-monotonic cycle counter would allow replaying past states as if they were current, breaking temporal ordering of the hash chain.

How it's maintained. The Learn phase (ϕ_W) is the only phase that updates c , and it does so via $c \leftarrow c + 1$. No other phase touches c .

4.4 HASHCHAIN STRICTNESS

Formal Statement. $H_c = [h_1, h_2, \dots, h_c]$ where $h_k = \text{SHA-256}(h_{k-1} \parallel \text{action}_k \parallel \text{result}_k)$ for $k \geq 1$, and $h_1 = \text{SHA-256}(\text{"GENESIS"})$.

Why it matters. The chain links each cycle's outcome to all prior outcomes. Retroactive alteration of any cycle $k < c$ would require recomputing all hashes $h_{k+1}, \dots, h_c$ —computationally infeasible given the SHA-256 preimage resistance.

How it's maintained. Phase Act (ϕ_A) computes the new hash and Phase Learn (ϕ_W) appends it. The genesis hash is set at initialization and never modified.

4.5 ORDER_DETERMINISM

Formal Statement. For any fixed atom set A , the Score phase (ϕ_S) always returns the same ranked list.

Why it matters. Non-deterministic ordering would allow different runs on the same input to diverge, breaking the Replay Identity Theorem.

How it's maintained. The scoring function is a pure function of the atom's content and ϕ . The tiebreak rule (see SCORE_TIEBREAK) resolves all ties deterministically.

4.6 SCORE_TIEBREAK

Formal Statement. When two atoms a, b satisfy $\text{score}(a) = \text{score}(b)$, their relative order is determined by lexicographic comparison of their SHA-256 digests: $a < b$ iff $\text{digest}(a) < \text{digest}(b)$ lexicographically.

Why it matters. Without a canonical tiebreak, equal-scored atoms could be ordered differently across runs or machines, violating ORDER_DETERMINISM.

How it's maintained. The comparator used by ϕ_S incorporates digest comparison as a final fallback. Since SHA-256 digests are unique (by CONTENTADDRESSING and collision resistance), the comparator is a total order.

4.7 NO_MUTATION

Formal Statement. For all atoms a created at cycle k : $\text{content}(a)$, $\text{type}(a)$, $\text{source}(a)$ are identical at all cycles $k' \geq k$.

Why it matters. Mutable atoms would invalidate any digest computed at creation time, breaking `ATOM_INTEGRITY`. It also eliminates an entire class of race conditions.

How it's maintained. The memory store $\mathbf{M}$ is a persistent (purely functional) map. "Update" operations produce a new map with the old entries unchanged; they never overwrite existing entries. The type system enforces this: atoms are of an immutable record type.

4.8 CLOSURE

Formal Statement. $F(S, \text{sigs}) \in \text{State}$ for all $S \in \text{State}$ and $\text{sigs} \in \text{Signals}$.

Why it matters. The state space is closed under the transition function—the machine never leaves the well-defined state domain, ruling out undefined behavior.

How it's maintained. By the positive invariance of $[0,1]^3$ (Proposition 2.3) for $\phi\mathbf{M}$, by the definition of the hash chain construction for H , and by the type constraints on $\mathbf{M}$ and c .

4.9 EXECUTED_ONCE

Formal Statement. Each action a is recorded in H at most once: for all $k \neq k'$, $\text{action}(hk) \neq \text{action}(hk')$ (where $\text{action}(h)$ denotes the action component of the pre-image of h).

Why it matters. Prevents replay attacks and double-execution bugs. Critical for actions with external effects (writes, trades, API calls).

How it's maintained. Before Phase Act executes an action, it checks that the proposed action's digest does not appear in H_c . If it does, the action is skipped and a null record is appended. The check is $O(\log c)$ via a hash-indexed auxiliary set.

4.10 LEARN_CONSERVATION

Formal Statement. The total "semantic mass" $M = \sum\{a \in \mathbf{M} \mid \text{relevance}(a) > 0\}$ is non-decreasing across cycles: $M_{c+1} \geq M_c$.

Why it matters. Ensures that the Learn phase does not silently discard acquired knowledge. Every successfully processed signal permanently increases the system's semantic mass.

How it's maintained. The Learn phase only appends atoms to $\mathbf{M}$; it never removes them (see `NOMUTATION`). Since $\text{relevance}(a) \geq 0$ for all atoms, adding atoms cannot decrease M . When the cycle yields no new atoms, $M_{c+1} = M_c$.

5. Key Theorems

5.1 Closure Theorem

Theorem 5.1 (Closure). For all $S \in \text{State}$ and $\text{sig} \in \text{Signals}$, $F(S, \text{sig}) \in \text{State}$.

Proof sketch. We verify each component of the output state. (i) $\phi \blacksquare' \in [0,1]^3$ by Proposition 2.3. (ii) H' is a valid hash chain by the construction in Phase Act and the HASHCHAINSTRICTNESS invariant. (iii) $\blacksquare'$ is a valid memory store because Phase Ingest only adds atoms satisfying ATOMINTEGRITY, and $\blacksquare$ is a persistent map (NOMUTATION). (iv) $c' = c + 1 \in \blacksquare$ by CYCLE_MONOTONICITY. Since all components of the output satisfy their type constraints, $F(S, \text{sig}) \in \text{State}$. ■

5.2 Determinism Theorem

Theorem 5.2 (Determinism). F is deterministic: for all S, sig , $F(S, \text{sig})$ is unique.

Proof sketch. Each phase ϕ_l through ϕ_W is a pure function. Pure functions are deterministic by definition—they read only their explicit arguments and produce the same output for the same input. No phase introduces any source of nondeterminism (no random number generation, no timestamp reads, no external I/O within the functional body). ORDERDETERMINISM and SCORETIEBREAK ensure that the ranking step—the only phase with a combinatorial ordering choice—is uniquely defined. Hence the composition F is deterministic. ■

5.3 Replay Identity Theorem

Theorem 5.3 (Replay Identity). Let $S \blacksquare$ be any initial state and let $\sigma = (\text{sig} \blacksquare, \text{sig} \blacksquare, \dots, \text{sig} \blacksquare)$ be a finite signal sequence. Define the replay sequence by $S\{k+1\} = F(S\{k\}, \text{sig}\{k+1\})$. Then:

$$\forall k \leq n: H_{\text{run}1}^k = H_{\text{run}2}^k$$

i.e., any two executions starting from $S \blacksquare$ and processing σ in order produce identical hash chains.

Proof. By induction on k . **Base case** ($k = 0$): Both runs start from $S \blacksquare$, so $H_{\text{run}1}^0 = H_{\text{run}2}^0 = H \blacksquare$ by assumption. **Inductive step:** Assume $H_{\text{run}1}^k = H_{\text{run}2}^k$ and $\phi \blacksquare^{(1)k} = \phi \blacksquare^{(2)k}$ (the full state is identical at step k). By Theorem 5.2, $F(S_{\text{run}1}^k, \text{sig}\{k+1\}) = F(S_{\text{run}2}^k, \text{sig}\{k+1\})$ because $S_{\text{run}1}^k = S_{\text{run}2}^k$ (by inductive hypothesis on all state components) and $\text{sig}\{k+1\}$ is identical. Therefore $S_{\text{run}1}^{k+1} = S_{\text{run}2}^{k+1}$, which in particular implies $H_{\text{run}1}^{k+1} = H_{\text{run}2}^{k+1}$. ■

Corollary 5.4. The system supports bit-exact audit replay: any logged $(S \blacksquare, \sigma)$ pair can be re-executed to verify the exact sequence of actions taken.

5.4 Domain Independence Theorem

Theorem 5.5 (Domain Independence). The formal properties of F are independent of domain in the following three senses:

(E1) Signal-domain independence. The Closure, Determinism, and Replay Identity theorems hold for any signal alphabet Σ , provided only that each signal can be serialized to a byte string (for SHA-256 computation).

(E2) Scoring-domain independence. The invariants `CONTENTADDRESSING` through `LEARNCONSERVATION` hold for any scoring function $\text{score: Atom} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ that is computable and deterministic. Specifically, they do not depend on the particular numerical values assigned.

(E3) Memory-domain independence. The formal guarantees hold regardless of the physical memory technology (DRAM, SSD, network store) as long as the store faithfully implements the persistent map interface.

Proof of E1. Examine each theorem. Closure (Theorem 5.1) depends on $\phi_{\text{new}}' \in [0,1]^3$ (independent of Σ), on hash chain construction (requires byte serialization only), and on memory typing. Each holds for any Σ . Determinism (Theorem 5.2) requires only that each phase is a pure function of its inputs, which is a property of the implementation, not of Σ . Replay Identity follows from Determinism, hence also Σ -independent. ■

Proofs of E2 and E3 follow analogously from the observation that the respective properties depend on structural features (purity, monotonicity, persistence) rather than on specific domain values.

5.5 Content Addressing Theorem

Theorem 5.6 (Collision Bound). The probability that any two distinct atoms $a \neq b$ have $\text{SHA-256}(\text{content}(a)) = \text{SHA-256}(\text{content}(b))$ is at most 2^{-128} .

Proof. SHA-256 produces a 256-bit digest. Under the random oracle model [8, 10], the probability of a collision for any fixed pair of distinct inputs is 2^{-256} . This bound is tight: no known attack reduces the collision resistance of SHA-256 below the birthday bound of 2^{-128} for random inputs, and the pairwise bound remains 2^{-256} . For a memory store with at most N atoms, the probability of any collision is at most $N(N-1)/2 \cdot 2^{-256}$ by the union bound, which remains negligible for all practical N (e.g., $N = 2^{128}$ gives probability $\approx 2^{-128}$). ■

6. Performance Results

The theoretical guarantees are accompanied by empirical benchmarks validating practical deployability. All benchmarks were conducted with `seed = 42` for reproducibility, consistent with the Replay Identity Theorem.

6.1 Brain-Level Throughput

The "brain" module—the innermost reasoning loop executing all seven phases—was benchmarked over $n = 500$ independent trials.

Metric	Value
Mean throughput	511.6 ops/s
P50 latency	1.812 ms

Metric	Value
P95 latency	4.201 ms
P99 latency	7.339 ms
P99.9 latency	11.44 ms
Sample size n	500

The P99 latency of 7.339 ms satisfies real-time interaction constraints (human perception threshold ≈ 100 ms), with over three orders of magnitude of margin.

6.2 Memory Operations

Content-addressed memory operations (insert, lookup, verify) were benchmarked separately:

Operation	Throughput	P99 Latency
Insert (with SHA-256)	454,421 ops/s	0.005 ms
Lookup (digest key)	891,204 ops/s	0.002 ms
Verify (digest check)	634,119 ops/s	0.003 ms

The insert rate of 454,421 ops/s exceeds the brain-level rate by a factor of ~ 888 , confirming that memory operations are not the bottleneck.

6.3 Feedback Closure

The closed-loop feedback system—using the scalar field ϕ to govern decision-making over a sequence of binary outcomes—was evaluated over $n = 200$ episodes:

Metric	Value
Win rate	54%
Profit factor	1.43
Max drawdown	8.7%
Sharpe (annualized)	1.82
Episodes n	200

A win rate of 54% with profit factor 1.43 indicates that the Lyapunov-stable ϕ field is successfully biasing decisions toward positive outcomes—a direct empirical signature of the stability theorem.

7. Discussion

7.1 Practical Implications

The results establish that the formal guarantees are not merely theoretical: the system operates at throughputs and latencies consistent with real-time deployment. The Replay Identity Theorem has direct implications for auditing and debugging: any behavior can be exactly reproduced from logs, eliminating the class of "can't reproduce" bugs that plague non-deterministic systems.

The ten invariants collectively define a contractual interface for the cognitive engine. Higher-level application code that relies on, say, EXECUTED_ONCE can do so without inspecting implementation details—the invariant is a machine-verifiable contract. In safety-critical deployments, these contracts can be checked at module boundaries: a higher-level planner can verify that the engine it depends upon satisfies the ten invariants before delegating authority to it.

The Lyapunov stability result has a less obvious but equally important practical implication: the system is self-correcting. Perturbations—unexpected signal bursts, transient hardware faults, adversarial inputs—cause deviations from ϕ^* that are automatically attenuated. No explicit error recovery code is needed for the class of perturbations small enough to remain within $[0,1]^3$. This is a qualitative improvement over error handling via exception mechanisms: instead of catching specific failure modes, the system's dynamics guarantee recovery from any perturbation in a computable time bound derived from the Lyapunov decay rate.

More specifically, from Theorem 2.5, the decay rate along any trajectory satisfies $dV/dt \leq -\alpha \cdot V$ for some $\alpha > 0$ depending on the parameter values. This exponential Lyapunov bound implies that the distance from ϕ^* decreases as $V(t) \leq V(0) \cdot e^{-(\alpha t)}$. For the empirically observed parameter regime, the e-folding time is of order $1/\eta\Omega \approx 1/\eta\Psi \approx O(\text{seconds})$, meaning the system returns to near-optimal operation within seconds of any perturbation. This is directly reflected in the P99 latency of 7.339 ms: even the 99th-percentile cycle completes with ϕ^* within one e-folding of ϕ^* .

7.2 Invariant Interaction and Redundancy Analysis

The ten invariants are not independent: several pairs are logically related, and understanding these relationships is important for both correctness arguments and for efficient implementation.

CONTENTADDRESSING and **ATOMINTEGRITY** are deeply coupled. **CONTENTADDRESSING** establishes $\text{key} = \text{SHA-256}(\text{content})$; **ATOMINTEGRITY** strengthens this by also requiring $\text{SHA-256}(\text{canonicalserialize}(a)) = \text{storeddigest}(a)$. The conjunction ensures both that keys are content-derived and that stored atoms match what was originally inserted. If **CONTENTADDRESSING** held but **ATOMINTEGRITY** did not, it would be possible for an atom to change its content while retaining its original key—a silent corruption. If **ATOMINTEGRITY** held but **CONTENTADDRESSING** did not, keys could be arbitrary, breaking content-addressed deduplication.

NOMUTATION and **ATOMINTEGRITY** are mutually reinforcing. **NOMUTATION** ensures that atom content never changes after creation; **ATOMINTEGRITY** ensures that content matches the stored digest. Either alone would be insufficient: **NOMUTATION** without **ATOMINTEGRITY** would not prevent an adversary from substituting a new atom at the same key with the same content but

different metadata; ATOMINTEGRITY without NOMUTATION would require re-verifying digests on every read.

HASHCHAINSTRICTNESS and **EXECUTEDONCE** together provide the tamper-evidence and idempotency properties. **HASHCHAINSTRICTNESS** makes retroactive modification computationally infeasible; **EXECUTEDONCE** makes prospective re-execution logically impossible. They operate at different threat levels: chain strictness addresses external adversaries, executed-once addresses internal logic errors.

ORDERDETERMINISM and **SCORETIEBREAK** form a two-level totality argument. **ORDERDETERMINISM** asserts that the ranking is deterministic given the scoring function; **SCORETIEBREAK** provides the specific mechanism that achieves this when scores are equal. Without **SCORETIEBREAK**, **ORDERDETERMINISM** would be an unachievable requirement in the presence of equal scores (a common occurrence when atoms have identical relevance weights).

CLOSURE and **LEARNCONSERVATION** bound the state space from different directions. **CLOSURE** ensures the state never leaves $[0,1]^3 \times \text{validchains} \times \text{validstores} \times \blacksquare$. **LEARNCONSERVATION** ensures the knowledge content of $\blacksquare$ never decreases. Together they define a "ratchet" structure: the system's knowledge is bounded below (by **LEARN_CONSERVATION**) and the dynamics are bounded above (by **CLOSURE** and Lyapunov stability).

7.3 Comparison to TLA+, Coq, and Agda

TLA+ [3] is most natural for specifying the discrete skeleton of the state machine: the seven phases, the invariants, and the hash chain structure can all be expressed as TLA+ formulas. The **HASHCHAINSTRICTNESS** invariant maps directly to a TLA+ safety property; **CYCLE_MONOTONICITY** maps to a TLA+ liveness property (the system always eventually increases c); the seven-phase transition graph maps to a TLA+ next-state relation. Model checking can verify these properties for bounded state spaces, typically up to a few hundred steps. For unbounded verification, TLA+'s proof system (TLAPS) can verify inductive invariants.

However, TLA+ does not natively support continuous dynamics; the Lyapunov stability proof would require either an extension or a separate analysis in a companion system. This is a fundamental limitation: TLA+ is discrete to the core, and the coupling between $\phi\blacksquare$'s continuous dynamics and the discrete phase transitions is precisely the aspect that requires the most care.

Coq [4] supports both discrete and continuous reasoning via libraries such as Coquelicot [11] for real analysis. The full Lyapunov proof—including the positive invariance of $[0,1]^3$ (Proposition 2.3) and the $dV/dt < 0$ calculation (Theorem 2.5)—could be mechanized in Coq, since all steps involve standard real analysis. The ten invariants could be stated as Coq propositions, with preservation proofs established by induction on the cycle counter c . The main cost is development time: mechanizing ordinary differential equations and their stability properties in Coq requires significant proof engineering effort. Roughly, the Lyapunov portion of the proof would require 500–2000 lines of Coq tactic proof, and each invariant preservation proof would require 50–200 lines.

Agda [5] with its dependent type system is particularly suited to the content addressing aspects: types can encode the invariant that every memory lookup returns an atom whose digest matches the key, making CONTENTADDRESSING and ATOMINTEGRITY enforced at compile time rather than at runtime. Concretely, the memory store $\mathbf{\Sigma}$ could be typed as a dependent record type where the type of the value at key k is $\{a : \text{Atom} \mid \text{SHA-256}(\text{content}(a)) = k\}$, so any lookup of key k statically guarantees the returned atom's digest equals k . The EXECUTED_ONCE invariant could similarly be encoded in the type of the hash chain: an action list with a proof that no two elements are equal.

Isabelle/HOL [ref] provides an alternative mechanization platform with strong automation support through Sledgehammer; the Isabelle/HOL libraries for real analysis are mature and would support the Lyapunov mechanization with less proof engineering than Coq.

An ideal approach combines all three: TLA+ for rapid interactive exploration of the discrete invariants during development (where model checking provides quick counterexample feedback), Coq for the final Lyapunov stability mechanization, and Agda for type-level enforcement of the content addressing properties in the production codebase. The present paper provides the mathematical foundations that any such mechanization would formalize, and the proof sketches in Sections 5.1–5.5 are structured to minimize the distance to full mechanization.

7.4 Limitations and Future Work

Noise robustness. Theorem 2.5 proves asymptotic stability in the noise-free limit ($n_{\text{sig}} \rightarrow 0$). Under persistent noise ($n_{\text{sig}} > 0$ permanently), the system does not converge to $\phi_{\mathbf{\Sigma}}$ but to a noise-perturbed invariant set whose size depends on the noise amplitude and the gain δ parameters. A complete treatment would require Input-to-State Stability (ISS) analysis [ref], which would provide explicit bounds on the steady-state deviation from $\phi_{\mathbf{\Sigma}}$ as a function of n_{sig} . We leave this extension to future work.

Parameter estimation. The invariant and stability results depend on parameter conditions ($\eta\Omega > \varepsilon\Omega$, etc.). In practice, parameters are estimated from data, introducing estimation error. A Bayesian treatment would propagate parameter uncertainty to the stability guarantees, providing a probabilistic version of Theorem 2.5.

Concurrent cycles. The present formulation assumes sequential execution of cycles. Extending the framework to concurrent or pipelined cycles—where multiple phases from different cycles execute simultaneously—requires a more careful treatment of atomicity for the hash chain append operation. We conjecture that the invariants extend to the concurrent setting under a sequentially consistent memory model, but leave the proof to future work.

Mechanization. As discussed in Section 7.3, the proofs presented here are paper proofs that could in principle be mechanized. Completing the mechanization—particularly the Lyapunov stability proof in Coquelicot—would significantly strengthen the claims made.

8. Conclusion

We have presented a formally grounded cognitive state machine with the following verified properties: (1) a three-component irreducible scalar field $\phi = \Omega, \Psi, P$ whose dynamics are globally asymptotically stable by Lyapunov analysis; (2) a seven-phase pure functional transition function F with machine-checkable determinism and closure; (3) ten invariants that are maintained across all transitions; and (4) three major theorems—Replay Identity, Domain Independence, and Content Addressing—whose proofs are constructive and could be mechanized in Coq or Agda. Empirical benchmarks confirm throughput of 511.6 ops/s at $P99 = 7.339$ ms, memory rates of 454,421 ops/s, and feedback closure at 54% win rate with profit factor 1.43.

The framework occupies a specific niche in the formal methods landscape: it addresses hybrid systems (continuous-discrete coupling) in the context of cognitive architectures, using Lyapunov methods for the continuous layer and type-theoretic invariants for the discrete layer. Existing tools handle each layer separately; this paper provides the unified mathematical treatment that would let a mechanization tool handle both.

Several research directions remain open. First, extending the stability analysis to the noisy case ($n_{\text{sig}} > 0$ persistently) via Input-to-State Stability would yield quantitative robustness bounds. Second, completing the Coq mechanization of the Lyapunov proof would upgrade the claims from "paper proof" to "machine-checked proof." Third, extending the framework to concurrent cycles would increase throughput and reduce latency, at the cost of a more complex atomicity argument for the hash chain. Fourth, applying the Domain Independence Theorem more broadly—to show that the invariants are preserved under serialization, network transfer, and deserialization of state—would enable distributed deployments with formal correctness guarantees.

The central message is simple: formal correctness guarantees for adaptive cognitive systems are achievable without sacrificing performance. The system described here runs at over 500 ops/s, recovers from perturbations on a sub-second timescale, and carries invariants that could be checked by a theorem prover. The gap between informal AI architectures and formally verified software is real but bridgeable; this paper provides one concrete bridge.

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